

漢字

KANJIDOKU

Sudoku that leaves you with a word

5 puzzles from the book

There are 110 in it.



Nine characters, not nine numbers

Kanjidoku is sudoku. If you have done a sudoku you already know the rule, and it does not change: every row, every column and every outlined box must contain each character exactly once.

The only difference is that the nine symbols are kanji instead of the digits 1 to 9. You do not need to know what they mean to solve the grid. A symbol is a symbol. But every puzzle prints its characters in a numbered key at the top of the page, with readings and meanings, and by the time you have written 火 nine times in nine different places you will find you know it.

That is the whole idea. Nobody learns a character by looking at it once. You learn it by needing it.

THE TWO TECHNIQUES YOU NEED

The last empty seat

Look at a single cell. Cross off every character that already appears in its row, its column and its box. If exactly one character survives, it goes there.

The only home left

Look at a single row, column or box and pick one character. Cross off every cell in that unit where the character cannot go. If exactly one cell survives, the character goes there.

No puzzle in this book needs anything harder than those two. If you find yourself wanting to guess, there is a move you have not spotted yet.

HOW TO PLAY

The word at the end

Two, three or four cells in every grid are shaded and carry a small number. They are always empty at the start, so you cannot read the word without solving the puzzle first.

When the grid is full, read those cells in numbered order. You will have a real Japanese word, built out of characters you have just spent twenty minutes with. Write it into the boxes at the foot of the page with its reading and meaning; the answer is at the back alongside the solved grid.

WORKED EXAMPLE

捕	獲	票	得	施	策 ^②
策	施	得	票	捕	獲
獲	策	施	捕	票	得
票	得	捕	獲	策	施
施	票	獲	策	得	捕
^① 得	捕	策	施	獲	票

This grid is already solved.

Cells 1 and 2 are shaded. Read them in that order:

得策 tokusaku
とくさく
profitable plan; good plan

Both characters were in the key at the top of the page all along, so you already have the reading and the meaning.

HOW THIS SAMPLE IS ORDERED

The grids grow one step at a time. Six by six, then eight and nine, with jigsaws between. Every grid here is N1, so within a size the sets are ordered by how common their characters are in print. Twelve of the hidden words run to four characters.

Two of them are jigsaws. Boxes have to be rectangles, so the size has to divide. Five and seven are prime, so those grids use irregular regions instead.

This book covers the commonest half of N1. N1 is about 1,200 characters, more than a hundred grids can hold. These are the 500 that turn up most often in print.

There is no writing practice, and no stroke order. The earlier books drill both. This one assumes you can write and spends the pages on ten more puzzles; its stroke orders are a free download at kanjidoku.net/strokes.

The clever thing to do

① 捕 ^{to raeru ho}
と(らえる) / ホ
catch; capture

② 獲 ^{e ru kaku}
え(る) / カク
seize; get

③ 得 ^{e ru toku}
え(る) / トク
gain; get

④ 策 ^{saku}
サク
scheme; plan

⑤ 施 ^{hodoko su shi se}
ほどこ(す) / シ・セ
give; bestow

⑥ 票 ^{hyō}
ヒョウ
ballot; label

		票			②
	施	得		捕	獲
	策		捕		
		捕		策	
施	票		策	得	
①			施		

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2
---	---

reading _____
meaning _____

Talking it through properly

① 討 u tsu tō
う(つ) / トウ
chastise; attack

② 議 gi
ギ
deliberation

③ 拘 kaka waru kō
かか(わる) / コウ
arrest; seize

④ 論 ron
ロン
argument; discourse

⑤ 旨 mune shi
むね / シ
delicious; relish

⑥ 唯 tada yui i
ただ / ユイ・イ
solely; only

⑦ 審 tsumabi raka shin
つまび(らか) / シン
hearing; judge

⑧ 閣 kaku
カク
tower; tall building

	議					審	旨
旨	論				討		
			討			唯	②
審	唯	論					討
閣					旨	討	論
	審			唯			
		唯				議	審
議	閣	①				論	

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2
---	---

reading _____
meaning _____

Ships in formation

① 雅 ^{miya bi ga}
みや(び) / ガ
gracious; elegant

② 楽 ^{tano shii gaku raku}
たの(しい) / ガク・ラク
music; comfort

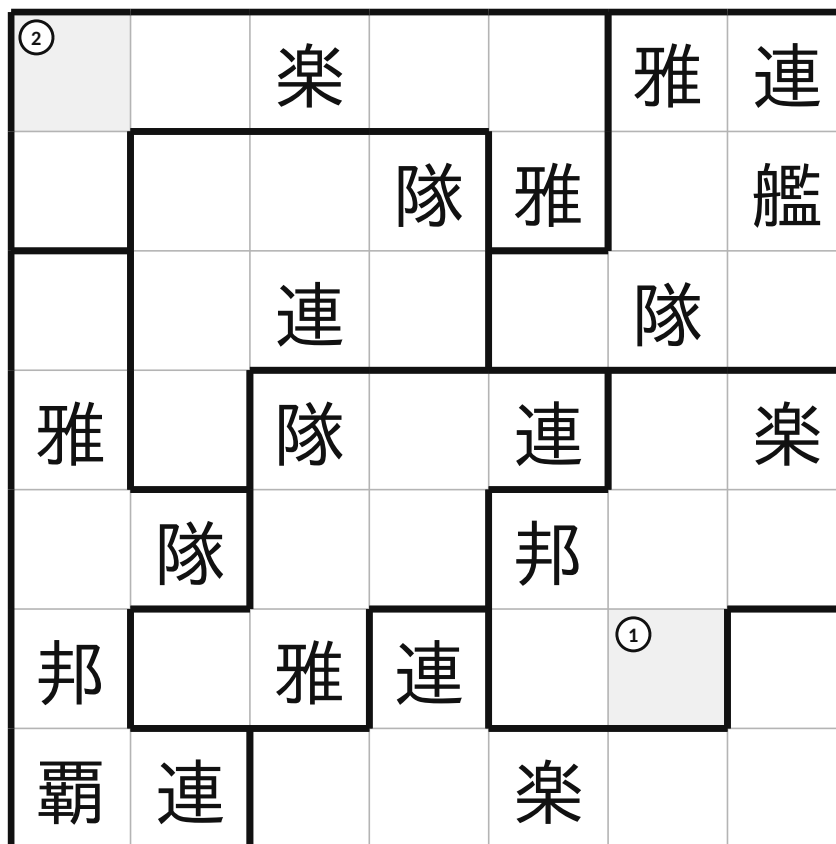
③ 隊 ^{tai}
タイ
regiment; party

④ 連 ^{tsura naru ren}
つら(なる) / レン
to link; to take along

⑤ 覇 ^{ha haku}
ハ・ハク
hegemony; supremacy

⑥ 邦 ^{kuni hō}
くに / ホウ
home country; country

⑦ 艦 ^{kan}
カン
warship



THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2
---	---

reading _____
meaning _____

The fast line

① 幹 ^{miki kan}
みき / カン

tree trunk; main part

② 線 ^{sen}
セン
line; track

③ 沿 ^{sō en}
そ(う) / エン
to run alongside

④ 射 ^{i ru sha}
い(る) / シャ
shoot; shine into

⑤ 放 ^{hana su hō}
はな(す) / ホウ
set free; release

⑥ 牧 ^{maki boku}
まき / ボク
breed; care for

⑦ 新 ^{new}
new
^{atara shii shin}
あた(ら)しい / シン

⑧ 郎 ^{rō ryō}
ロウ・リョウ
man (in names)

⑨ 潟 ^{kata seki}
かた / セキ
lagoon

		幹			牧		沿	潟
		放	③		幹			
潟	線				沿			放
幹					線		牧	
	牧			沿			郎	①
	新		郎					線
射			沿				潟	幹
			射			放		
放	潟		牧	②		沿		

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2	3
---	---	---

reading _____

meaning _____

Playing behind the singer

- ① 合 ^{a u} あ(う) / ^{gō gatsu} ゴウ・ガツ
to fit; to combine
- ② 成 ^{na ru} な(る) / ^{sei jō} セイ・ジョウ
turn into; become
- ③ 繊 ^{sen} セン
slender; fine
- ④ 維 ⁱ イ
fiber; tie
- ⑤ 功 ^{isao} いさお / ^{kō ku} コウ・ク
achievement; merits
- ⑥ 促 ^{unaga su soku} うなが(す) / ソク
stimulate; urge
- ⑦ 奏 ^{kana deru sō} かな(でる) / ソウ
to play music
- ⑧ 伴 ^{tomona u} ともな(う) / ^{han ban} ハン・バン
consort; accompany
- ⑨ 熟 ^{u reru juku} う(れる) / ジュク
mellow; ripen

	②				促	合		熟
合								繊
伴	功		成					
成				伴	奏	熟		
奏			合		維			功
		合	功	成				促
					成		維	奏
維								成
功		奏	繊					①

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2

reading _____

meaning _____

Solutions

Characters in grey are the ones you had to work out; black ones were given. The note under each word is the reason that word was worth hiding.

捕	獲	票	得	施	策 ^②
策	施	得	票	捕	獲
獲	策	施	捕	票	得
票	得	捕	獲	策	施
施	票	獲	策	得	捕
得 ^①	捕	策	施	獲	票

1. THE CLEVER THING TO DO

得策 とくさく
profitable plan; good plan

得 is to gain, and it sets up against loss in 損得 (そんとく, sontoku), profit and loss. A 得策 is the course that pays: advice offered on grounds of advantage rather than principle, and usually phrased in the negative: 得策ではない, it would not be wise.

唯	議	討	閣	拘	論	審	旨
旨	論	拘	審	議	討	閣	唯
拘	旨	閣	討	論	審	唯 ^②	議
審	唯	論	議	閣	拘	旨	討
閣	拘	議	唯	審	旨	討	論
討	審	旨	論	唯	議	拘	閣
論	討	唯	拘	旨	閣	議	審
議	閣	審 ^①	旨	討	唯	論	拘

25. TALKING IT THROUGH PROPERLY

審議 しんぎ
deliberation

議 is to deliberate, and it is everywhere: a 会議 (かいぎ, kaigi) is a meeting, 国会 is the Diet. 審議 adds the examining sense of 審, so it is deliberation with scrutiny in it: what a committee does to a bill, rather than what a meeting does to an agenda.

隊 ^②	邦	榮	霸	艦	雅	連
連	霸	邦	隊	雅	榮	艦
艦	雅	連	榮	霸	隊	邦
雅	艦	隊	邦	連	霸	榮
榮	隊	霸	艦	邦	連	雅
邦	榮	雅	連	隊	艦 ^①	霸
霸	連	艦	雅	榮	邦	隊

50. SHIPS IN FORMATION

艦隊 かんたい
fleet; armada

艦 is a warship, as opposed to 船 for any vessel; a 軍艦 (ぐんかん, gunkan) spells it out. 隊 is a formation or a corps. A 艦隊 is a fleet in the military sense, and the character 艦 appears in almost nothing else.

新	射	幹	放	郎	牧	線	沿	漚
郎	沿	放	③線	漚	幹	新	射	牧
漚	線	牧	新	射	沿	郎	幹	放
幹	放	郎	漚	新	線	射	牧	沿
線	牧	射	幹	沿	放	漚	郎	④新
沿	新	漚	郎	牧	射	幹	放	線
射	郎	線	沿	放	新	牧	漚	幹
牧	幹	沿	射	線	漚	放	新	郎
放	漚	新	牧	②幹	郎	沿	線	射

58. THE FAST LINE

新幹線

shinkansen
しんかんせん

Shinkansen; bullet train

幹 is a tree trunk and by extension the main line of anything: the 幹部 of a company are its trunk, its executives. A 幹線 is a trunk railway line, and the 新幹線 is the new one: a name chosen in the 1950s that has never needed replacing.

織	②奏	成	維	功	促	合	伴	熟
合	促	維	熟	奏	伴	成	功	織
伴	功	熟	成	織	合	奏	促	維
成	維	功	促	伴	奏	熟	織	合
奏	織	促	合	熟	維	伴	成	功
熟	伴	合	功	成	織	維	奏	促
促	熟	織	伴	合	成	功	維	奏
維	合	伴	奏	促	功	織	熟	成
功	成	奏	織	維	熟	促	合	①伴

70. PLAYING BEHIND THE SINGER

伴奏

bansō
ばんそう
accompaniment

奏 is to play an instrument and 伴 is to accompany, and 伴奏 is what the pianist does while somebody else is being listened to. The same 奏 makes 演奏 (えんそう, ensō), a performance: the thing 伴奏 is deliberately not the centre of.

There are a hundred and five more

Volume Four holds **110 puzzles** and 500 of the most common characters of N1, each with its readings and meaning printed on the page you meet it.

Full solutions. Every grid worked out, with the hidden word, its reading and a note on where the word turns up in real Japanese.

A complete index. All 705 characters, with every puzzle each one appears in, for when one turns up three grids later and you cannot place it.

Ten more puzzles. The earlier books end with writing practice. This one assumes you can write, and spends those pages on ten more grids.

THE SERIES

Kanjidoku N5 and N4. Where the series starts: about 280 characters, six four-by-four warm-ups, and the vocabulary everything after it assumes.

Kanjidoku N3. About 370 characters, and the compounds the sets here treat as ordinary words.

Kanjidoku N2. About 370 more, and the book just before this one.

PLEASE SHARE THIS

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KANJIDOKU.NET for the rest of the series, and the other samplers



MIND QUESTS